Week 10: Collective Security

LAWS2000/8015 International Law

1. **What are some of the principal organs of the United Nations and their functions in relation to the maintenance of international peace and security?**

2. **Scenario:** After a coup d'état in the state of Aeystan, fighting breaks out between various armed factions across the country. It is unclear who is currently holding power in Ayestan, and the country risks sinking into a protracted civil war – with devastating humanitarian consequences for civilian populations. Thousands have already fled across the borders. The neighbouring countries of Belandia and Ceria support different armed factions in Aeystan through the supply of arms and training. Journalists have even spotted troops of both countries in Aeystan, but Belandia and Ceria continue to deny their involvement. A regional organisation of which all three countries are members – the ABC Union – appeals to the UN Security Council for action to restore international peace and security.

    a. **What steps must the UN Security Council follow in maintaining or restoring international peace and security?**

    b. **What coercive means – including those involving force and those not involving force – does the UN Security Council have at its disposal and how could these be employed in this scenario? Discuss by reference to relevant Charter provisions and practice.**

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